



Swift on her Reputation Stadium Tour in 2018

which her critics denounced her as a fake and calculating "snake".^[137] In late 2016, after briefly dating the actor Tom Hiddleston, Swift began a six-year relationship with the actor Joe Alwyn and went on hiatus.^{[138][139]}

In August 2017, Swift countersued and won a case against David Mueller, a former radio jockey for KYGO-FM, who sued her for damages from loss of employment. Four years earlier, she informed Mueller's employer that he had sexually assaulted her by groping her at an event.^[140] Public controversies influenced Swift's sixth album, Reputation, which explores themes of fame, drama, and finding love amidst the tumultuous affairs.^[141] Released on November 10, 2017,^[142] Reputation opened atop the Billboard 200 with 1.21 million US sales^[143] and also reached number one in Australia,^[144] Canada,^[145] and the UK.^[146]

Reputation's lead single, "Look What You Made Me Do", topped the Billboard Hot 100 with the highest sales and streaming week of 2017,^[147] and was Swift's first UK number-one single.^[148] The singles "...Ready for It?", "End Game", and "Delicate" were released to pop radio and all peaked in the top 20 of the Billboard Hot 100.^[149] In 2018, Swift featured on Sugarland's "Babe",^[150] surpassed Whitney Houston as the most-awarded female musician at the American Music Awards,^[151] and embarked on the Reputation Stadium Tour, which grossed \$345.7 million worldwide.^[152]

2018–2021: *Lover*, *Folklore*, and *Evermore*

In November 2018, Swift signed a record deal with Universal Music Group, which promoted her albums under Republic Records' imprint.^[153] The contract included a provision allowing Swift to maintain ownership of her master recordings. In addition, if Universal sold any part of its stake in Spotify, it agreed to distribute a non-recoupable portion of the proceeds to its artists.^{[154][155]}

Swift's first album with Republic Records and seventh overall, Lover, was released on August 23, 2019.^[156] She produced the album with Antonoff, Louis Bell, Frank Dukes, and Joel Little.^[157] Lover peaked atop the charts of such countries as Australia, Canada, Ireland, Mexico, Norway, Sweden, the UK, and the US,^[158] and was the global best-selling album by a solo artist of 2019.^[159] Three of its singles—"Me!", "You Need to Calm Down", and "Lover"—were released in 2019 and peaked in the top 10 of the Billboard Hot 100. "The Man" was released in 2020 and charted highly, and "Cruel Summer" became a resurgent success in 2023, reaching number one.^[160]

In 2019, Swift was honored as Artist of the Decade by the American Music Awards and Woman of the Decade by Billboard,^{[161][162]} and became the first female artist to win Video of the Year for a self-directed video with "You Need to Calm Down" at the MTV Video Music Awards.^[163] During the promotion of Lover, Swift became embroiled in a public dispute with the talent manager Scooter Braun after he



Swift at the American Music Awards of 2019, where she was named Artist of the Decade